CONTRACTORLEADS.US: COST PER LEAD & INFRASTRUCTURE ANALYSIS

Prepared for Management | System: Waterfall Lead Enrichment & Email Verifier | Date: November 2026 | Currency: USD ($)

1. FIXED HOSTING & INFRASTRUCTURE ALLOCATION ($17.00 / MONTH RAILWAY)

Railway hosting costs a flat fee of $17.00 per month for the Next.js application, background workers, and PostgreSQL database. Because this cost is fixed, the infrastructure cost per lead decreases directly as monthly lead volume increases:

MONTHLY LEAD VOLUME	TOTAL RAILWAY COST	RAILWAY ALLOCATION PER LEAD	IMPACT ON UNIT ECONOMICS
1,000 leads / month	$17.00 / month	**$0.0170 (1.70 cents)**	Early stage / low volume baseline
2,500 leads / month (Standard Baseline)	$17.00 / month	**$0.0068 (0.68 cents)**	Active customer base benchmark ($0.007 / lead)
5,000 leads / month	$17.00 / month	**$0.0034 (0.34 cents)**	High efficiency scaling target
10,000 leads / month	$17.00 / month	**$0.0017 (0.17 cents)**	Near-zero marginal server cost

2. COMPLETE MASTER TABLE: ALL SERVICES, APIS & FULL PRICE PER LEAD

The table below details every API, third-party service, and server infrastructure cost. The last column shows the full all-in price per lead including both the direct API cost and the Railway server infrastructure share (calculated at the standard 2,500 leads/month baseline):

SERVICE / PROVIDER	PIPELINE ROLE	PACKAGE / PLAN COST	DIRECT API UNIT COST	RAILWAY SHARE (2.5K)	FULL ALL-IN PRICE PER LEAD
Railway Hosting	Next.js Server & Database	$17.00 / month flat	Shared server	$0.0070	**$0.0070 (0.70 cents)**
Internal DB & Scraper	Stages 1 & 2 (Checked 1st)	Included on server ($0)	$0.0000	+$0.0070	**$0.0070 (0.70 cents)**
Serper.dev (Google Search)	Stage 3 (Owner & Snippets)	$50 for 50,000 queries	$0.0010	+$0.0070	**$0.0080 (0.80 cents)**
NinjaPear (Nubela)	Stage 4.4 (Company & Execs)	$10 for 1,000 lookups	$0.0100	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0180 (1.80 cents)**
Apollo.io (Paid Plan)	Stage 4.1 (External People Match)	$49 for 2,500 credits	$0.0196	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0276 (2.76 cents)**
Prospeo.io v2	Stage 4.2 (Verified Email & Phone)	$39 for 1,000 credits	$0.0300	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0380 (3.80 cents)**
Hunter.io	Stage 4.3 (Email Finder Fallback)	$49 for 500 searches	$0.0350	+$0.0070 +$0.001 Serper	**$0.0430 (4.30 cents)**
ZeroBounce	7-Step Verification Safety	$15 for 5,000 checks	$0.0030	Applied on external emails	**$0.0030 (0.30 cents)**
Hostinger Mail Relay	Warmup & Relay Dispatch	Included in domains ($0)	$0.0000	+$0.0000	**$0.0000 (0.00 cents)**

3. EXACT COST PER LEAD BY OUTCOME SCENARIO

Because the enrichment engine operates as a sequential waterfall, execution stops the instant verified contact details are found. The exact cost per lead depends on which stage resolves the contact:

OUTCOME SCENARIO	PIPELINE STAGES & APIS TRIGGERED	DIRECT API COST	RAILWAY COST	FULL ALL-IN PRICE YOU PAY
Scenario A: Internal DB or Website Scrape (approx 40% of leads)	Internal DB query + direct website crawl	$0.0000	$0.0070	**$0.0070 (0.70 cents)**
Scenario B: Google Serper Search (approx 25% of leads)	Serper search query + website snippet parse	$0.0010	$0.0070	**$0.0080 (0.80 cents)**
Scenario C: Apollo.io Match (approx 15% of leads)	Serper ($0.001) + Apollo Match ($0.0196)	$0.0206	$0.0070	**$0.0276 (2.76 cents)**
Scenario D: Prospeo.io Match (approx 15% of leads)	Serper ($0.001) + Prospeo Person ($0.0300)	$0.0310	$0.0070	**$0.0380 (3.80 cents)**
Scenario E: Complete Miss / Unresolvable (approx 5% of leads)	Serper ($0.001). Prospeo/Apollo do not charge on miss	$0.0010	$0.0070	**$0.0080 (0.80 cents)**

Weighted Blended Average Cost Per Lead:
(40% x $0.0070) + (25% x $0.0080) + (15% x $0.0276) + (15% x $0.0380) + (5% x $0.0080) =
$0.0150 per lead
. When external safety verification (ZeroBounce at $0.0030) is added to external provider hits, the
total all-inclusive blended average cost is approximately $0.018 to $0.020 (1.8 to 2.0 cents) per lead
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4. CUSTOMER PRICING, REVENUE & NET PROFIT MARGINS

When a user enriches a lead, the system deducts 1 credit (configured in Admin Console). The table below compares your real all-in cost against customer subscription revenue:

CUSTOMER SUBSCRIPTION PLAN	PLAN PRICE & CREDITS	REVENUE VALUE PER CREDIT	YOUR ALL-IN COST PER LEAD	NET PROFIT PER LEAD	NET MARGIN (%)
Starter Plan	$39.00 / month (250 credits)	$0.1560	~$0.0200	**+$0.1360 per lead**	**87.2% profit**
Growth Plan	$79.00 / month (1,000 credits)	$0.0790	~$0.0200	**+$0.0590 per lead**	**74.7% profit**
Agency Plan	$149.00 / month (2,500 credits)	$0.0596	~$0.0200	**+$0.0396 per lead**	**66.4% profit**

5. OPERATIONAL SUMMARY

- **Zero-Cost-First Architecture:** Approximately 65% of all lead requests are resolved via the internal database, direct website parsing, or Google web search before any paid external API is called.
- **No-Charge-On-Miss Guarantee:** External providers (Prospeo, Apollo) only deduct credits when real matching data is returned; unresolvable leads incur no external API cost.
- **Hosting Stability:** Railway hosting at $17.00 per month is fixed, resulting in higher gross margins as lead enrichment volume grows.